



ALIENS™

SKOAR!

COLONIAL MARINES

A Classic Desecrated

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Alien: Colonial Marines is the official sequel to the 1986 Aliens movie, or at least that's how Gearbox (the developer) and 20th Century Fox want to treat it. Its campaign picks up some-time after the disastrous events that occurred at LV-426, with a new squad of marines sent in to explore the abandoned Sulaco spaceship and the remains of Hadley's Hope. Unfortunately, that's probably the best summation we can give you about the plot of the game.

The game follows a squad of marines as they go through the wreckage of the Sulaco, battling Xenomorphs and rogue Weyland-Yutani soldiers. While the game is a first-person-shooter, it is unfortunate that the combat is so bad.

The first thing you notice about the game are its incredibly mediocre graphics. One would think that with big names like Gearbox (of Borderlands fame) and 20th Century Fox behind the project, there would be some sort of spit and polish to the game. There are jagged edges everywhere, a significant lack of textures and the lighting is just plain flat. While the graphics may be a serious let-down, the environment on the other hand is quite a different story. Gearbox has

put in a serious amount of effort into recreating the scenes and visuals from the original Aliens movie; details such as the glimpse of Bishop's dismembered body strewn across the deck of the Sulaco and a very careful re-render of the mechanical weight lifting rig that Ripley used in the original movie to fight off the Alien Queen. The mediocre graphics however make the joy of seeing such memorabilia a lot less exciting.

The second thing you notice is just how dumb the AI of the game is. This particular reviewer remembers watching the original Aliens movie and being petrified out of his wits by the Xenomorphs, creatures who had come to embody the epitome of "intelligent hunting." They stalked their prey, followed it around and terrified it before sending them to a horrifying death. It's probably the reason this particular reviewer is still terrified of lizards. However, the Xenomorphs in the game just kind of throw themselves at you, as if they just want to give you a hug. Desperately. And it isn't that the Wey-Yu soldiers are any better. The worst part about the game happens to be that after putting up with the awful gameplay for the 6-8 hours or so the game ends with an incredibly simple "boss fight" with the Queen Xenomorph. Underwhelming doesn't even come close. The game may have no proper storyline, or might be built on an aged engine, but it does

pay due homage to a film that spawned a cult following. The multiplayer mode is somewhat of a saving grace though, where you can either choose to play as a human or an alien. Choosing to play as a Xeno is rather exciting, as you can perform some really cool moves like spitting acid or leaping 30 feet straight to your target followed by dismembering them. But all that too wears off eventually. ★

Verdict

This is a disappointing game. Don't play it. Unless you're a die hard fan of course, then you'll probably suffer through it for the sake of what little story there is.

MOAR!

- » **Genre:** FPS
- » **Developer:** Gearbox software
- » **Publisher:** Sega
- » **Price:** Steam (₹2,700)



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